

From Zero to First Email

Resend email integration guide

1. What this integration does

- â€¢ Resend sends application emails through an HTTPS API. This avoids SMTP port restrictions on Render Free.
- â€¢ The existing application flows remain unchanged: Book a demo notifications, password resets, worker invitations, and admin emails.
- â€¢ The backend automatically uses Resend when RESEND_API_KEY is present. SMTP remains the fallback when it is not set.

2. Create your Resend account

- â€¢ Go to resend.com and create or sign in to your account.
- â€¢ Use an account owned by the Dechub-Bridge team so future administrators can access the email history and domain settings.

3. Add the sender domain

- â€¢ In Resend, open Domains and click Add domain.
- â€¢ Enter `bridge.dechub.ai`. Enter the domain only. Do not enter `https://` and do not add a trailing slash.
- â€¢ Choose Manual setup unless the DNS for `dechub.ai` is managed in the connected Cloudflare account and you want Resend to create the records automatically.

DNS Verification

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4. Add the Resend DNS records

- ⚠ Keep the Resend DNS Records screen open. It will show TXT, MX, and CNAME records with unique values.
- ⚠ Open the DNS provider that manages dechub.ai. This may be Cloudflare, GoDaddy, Namecheap, Hostinger, or another registrar. It is not Render or Vercel.
- ⚠ For every Resend row, create a new DNS record using the exact Type, Name or Host, and Value or Content shown by Resend. Keep the default TTL or choose Auto.
- ⚠ If Cloudflare is your DNS provider, set Resend CNAME records to DNS only (grey cloud), not Proxied (orange cloud).
- ⚠ Do not delete or replace the existing bridge.dechub.ai A or CNAME record used by the live application. Add only the new records Resend requests.

5. Verify the domain

- ⚠ Return to Resend and click Verify DNS records if that button is displayed.
- ⚠ Wait until bridge.dechub.ai changes from Not Started or Pending to Verified. DNS changes may take a few minutes and occasionally longer.
- ⚠ Do not proceed with production sender testing until the domain is Verified.

Backend Configuration

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6. Create a Resend API key

- â€¢ In Resend, open API Keys and click Create API Key.
- â€¢ Use a clear name such as Bridge Render Production and choose Sending access.
- â€¢ Copy the key that begins with re_. Resend displays the full value only once. Treat it like a password.

7. Configure Render

- â€¢ Open the Render service that deploys the Dechub backend. Do not add this secret to Vercel or the frontend.
- â€¢ Open Environment and add these three separate values:
 - â€¢ RESEND_API_KEY = re_your_actual_key_from_resend
 - â€¢ EMAIL_FROM = Dechub-Bridge <noreply@bridge.dechub.ai>
 - â€¢ CLIENT_URL = https://bridge.dechub.ai
- â€¢ Save the values and redeploy the backend service. SMTP values may remain empty when Resend is used.

8. Security rules

- â€¢ Never commit the API key to GitHub, place it in client-side code, or share it in screenshots.
- â€¢ If the key is exposed, revoke it in Resend and create a replacement immediately.

Testing and Troubleshooting

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9. Test delivery

- â€¢ Submit a Book a demo form or use Forgot password in the live application.
- â€¢ Open Resend, select Emails, and confirm the email appears with a sent or delivered status.
- â€¢ Check the recipient inbox and spam folder. The sender should be `noreply@bridge.dechub.ai`.

10. Common issues

- â€¢ Domain is Not Started or Pending: DNS records are missing, incorrect, or still propagating. Compare every record with Resend.
- â€¢ Resend rejects the sender: EMAIL_FROM must use a verified domain, for example `noreply@bridge.dechub.ai`.
- â€¢ No email in Resend: confirm RESEND_API_KEY is present in the Render backend service and redeploy after saving it.
- â€¢ Email is in Resend but not inbox: check spam and confirm the DNS records remain verified.
- â€¢ Render SMTP timeout: this is expected on Render Free when using SMTP. Configure RESEND_API_KEY so the application uses HTTPS instead.

11. Operational checklist

- â€¢ Domain Verified in Resend.
- â€¢ API key stored only in Render backend Environment.
- â€¢ EMAIL_FROM uses `bridge.dechub.ai`.
- â€¢ Book a demo and password-reset tests received successfully.